

International Banking Products AFC Bank Can Adapt for Gen Z and Pensioners in Zimbabwe

Executive summary

AFC Bank already has key “delivery rails” that make it realistic to adapt modern international banking concepts quickly: AFC’s individual current/savings accounts are **multi-currency (USD, ZWL, ZAR and other tradable currencies)**, **SMS-alert enabled**, and accessible through **internet banking, mobile app, and USSD *276#** (“AFC Link channels”). ¹ AFC’s mobile app listing also indicates day-to-day capabilities such as **bill payments, transfers, statement download, beneficiaries, and biometric login**, supporting digital-first rollouts without rebuilding the whole stack. ²

This report proposes **10 international-derived product proposals** (5 Gen Z, 5 pensioner) that either (a) have **no clearly documented Zimbabwe equivalent** based on publicly available product pages, or (b) strongly **complement AFC’s existing capabilities** (multi-currency + USSD/app channels + development/agriculture identity). In Zimbabwe, regulators and safety-net framing matter; the **Deposit Protection Corporation (DPC)** states membership is mandatory for all licensed deposit-taking institutions regulated by RBZ and includes commercial banks and POSB (among others), supporting trust messaging for new segment products. ³

From a demand lens, ZimStat’s **2023 Economic Census preliminary results** indicate that a **majority of establishments are informal** and highlight large volumes of informal micro-establishments, which supports designing Gen Z products for irregular-income lifestyles and low-friction digital money management. ⁴ For pensioners, NSSA communications emphasize fee sensitivity and benefits: pensioners banking with POSB and NBS have been cited as enjoying **zero transaction charges**, and NSSA has pointed to **discounted groceries schemes**—signals that “fee relief + savings + discounts + safety” value propositions can resonate. ⁵

Assumptions and methodology

Gen Z is assumed as **ages ~13–29**; pensioners are **retirees receiving pensions** (including NSSA and other pension arrangements). “Not currently offered in Zimbabwe” is judged conservatively as: **no clearly documented equivalent** found on major Zimbabwean banks’ official product pages and public descriptions reviewed, *not* a guarantee that no institution offers something similar privately. “Similar” is judged at a **functional level** (core use-case and core features). ⁶

International precedents are cited from **official product pages** (or official help/feature pages on the bank/fintech’s primary domain where the product is implemented in-app). ⁷

AFC baseline and Zimbabwe context that shapes implementation

AFC's baseline capability matters because several proposals are "feature layers" rather than entirely new businesses: AFC already provides multi-currency availability and access through app/USSD/internet banking, plus transaction SMS alerts. ⁸ This means AFC can ship "experience products" (controls, pots, alerts, access delegation) by combining **core banking configuration + channel UX + policy/process + partnerships**.

Zimbabwe's structure supports focusing on:

- **Gen Z:** digital-first, low-friction tools for budgeting and safety, especially for irregular incomes in an economy with a strong informal component. ⁴
- **Pensioners:** fee relief, predictable access, discount ecosystems, and safer financial management with trusted-family support. ⁹

Product proposals for Gen Z

AFC Teen+ Parent Controls Account

Description (one paragraph)

A teen sub-account (ages ~13–17) that sits under a parent/guardian's primary AFC profile, combining a teen debit card + app/USSD access with **guardian-set controls**. Internationally, Revolut's Kids & Teens product shows a pattern where a parent/guardian onboards the child and the teen can transact and save toward goals, with card controls available in-app. ¹⁰

Key features

A teen "sub-wallet" under the guardian profile; guardian-set limits (ATM, online, contactless); merchant category controls; allowance scheduling; "goals" pot; teen-to-teen transfers (optional, age-gated); real-time spend notifications to guardian. ¹⁰

Complementary services (partner types + value-add)

A school/college partner program for onboarding drives; payment acceptance partners for student spend ecosystems; optional youth financial education content partners (NGOs/education platforms).

Implementation steps (with compliance notes)

- 1) Define age tiers and controls (13–15 vs 16–17) and map to AFC USSD/app menus.
- 2) Update onboarding/KYC policy: guardian full KYC + minor verification; capture parental consent and audit logs (consumer protection + safeguarding).
- 3) Card program enhancements: introduce teen card BIN/rules with lower default limits; enable toggles for ATM/online/contactless.
- 4) Build guardian controls UI in app; add USSD basics (balance, mini statement, allowance confirmation).
- 5) Add alerts: instant "teen spending" SMS/app push to guardian (AFC already supports SMS alerts). ¹
- 6) Pilot in 2–3 urban branches + 1 rural corridor; add a school/college onboarding week.

Complexity / time-to-market

Medium; **~2–4 months** (faster if card processor supports granular controls).

Why it works in Zimbabwe

It gives parents in a largely informal and cash-heavy environment a safer on-ramp for teens to learn digital money while maintaining controls—similar to global “parent-supervised independence” models. ¹¹

Customer benefits

Teens get independence, budgeting habits, and safer cashless spending; guardians reduce cash-handling risk and can monitor/limit spend.

Bank benefits

Household acquisition (parent + teen); more card usage and payments volume; stronger deposit stickiness via family relationship banking.

Zimbabwe equivalent?

Yes (partial). Youth/junior products exist, but public pages often emphasize the account’s existence rather than explicit parental control tooling. Example youth/junior offerings: POSB Youth Account (10–24) and CBZ CashPlus Junior (under 12, operated by parent/guardian). ¹²

International precedent

Revolut Kids & Teens (product overview) and card controls help pages. ¹⁰

AFC RoundUp Goals Pots

Description

An “automatic micro-savings” feature that rounds up card and digital transactions to the nearest threshold and sweeps the difference into named savings pots (e.g., “Data Bundles,” “Laptop,” “Driver’s License,” “Farming Inputs”). Monzo documents how roundups take small amounts from purchases and move them into a savings pot. ¹³

Key features

Roundups toggle per card/account; selectable rounding rules; multiple goals/pots; progress dashboard; optional “lock” periods for certain pots; USSD “pots status” menu for feature-phone users.

Complementary services

Retail partners for goal categories (devices, data bundles, exam fees); optional rewards for consistent saving behavior (merchant-funded).

Implementation steps (with compliance notes)

- 1) Core configuration: create “sub-ledger pots” for customer accounts and a roundup sweep engine.
- 2) Channel UX: update AFC Link app and USSD to create/manage pots; add clear disclosures (how roundups work, reversals policy).
- 3) Payments integration: trigger roundups on eligible transaction types (card, ZIPIT, bill pay) while excluding reversals/declines.
- 4) Risk/controls: rate-limit sweeps; ensure customers can pause/stop; implement customer support scripts for disputes.
- 5) Pilot with employees + small youth cohort; expand after 4–6 weeks of monitoring.

Complexity / time-to-market

Low–Medium; ~6–10 weeks.

Why it works in Zimbabwe

It supports savings behavior with tiny, painless increments—ideal for Gen Z with variable incomes and high transaction frequency in digital channels. It also complements AFC's existing digital rails (app/USSD) and SMS alerts for transparency. ¹⁴

Customer benefits

Effortless saving; visible progress to goals; reduced “I can’t save” friction.

Bank benefits

Higher deposit balances; increased app engagement; differentiates AFC without heavy credit risk.

Zimbabwe equivalent?

N/A (no clear publicly documented equivalent found). Savings accounts exist, but roundup automation is not prominently documented on major Zimbabwe bank product pages reviewed (contrast with standard youth and junior accounts). ¹²

International precedent

Monzo “Understanding roundups” and “Advanced roundups” documentation. ¹³

AFC Virtual Card and Subscription Shield**Description**

A “safe online spending” package: customers can generate **virtual cards** (including **single-use** cards) and route subscriptions through dedicated virtual cards to reduce fraud exposure and make subscription management easier. Revolut's virtual card offerings describe virtual cards stored in-app and single-use cards for one-time payments; it also highlights freezing cards in-app. ¹⁵

Key features

Instant virtual card issuance in-app; single-use virtual cards; freeze/unfreeze; merchant-specific virtual cards for subscriptions; in-app “subscriptions list” showing recurring merchants (phase 2); transaction alerts and suspicious-merchant prompts.

Complementary services

Card network/tokenization partners; e-commerce merchant partners; consumer education content partners (online safety).

Implementation steps (with compliance notes)

- 1) Card processor readiness assessment: confirm support for tokenization + virtual PAN + dynamic CVV (or single-use virtual) features.
- 2) Fraud policy: define “safe defaults” for Gen Z (lower limits on new merchants; prompts for recurring charges).
- 3) In-app build: “Create virtual card” flows; “single-use” defaults; subscription routing options; freeze/

unfreeze controls.

4) Customer communications: clear disclosures on fraud liability, chargebacks, dispute processes, and data privacy.

5) Operational readiness: train support teams to handle subscription disputes and card credential resets.

Complexity / time-to-market

Medium-High; **~3-6 months** (depends on issuer processor capabilities).

Why it works in Zimbabwe

Gen Z adoption of online subscriptions and digital commerce is increasing, while card fraud and unwanted recurring charges are universal pain points; virtual cards reduce exposure and can help customers “ring-fence” subscriptions. ¹⁶

Customer benefits

Safer online spending; faster response to fraud (delete virtual card vs replace physical); cleaner subscription control.

Bank benefits

Higher digital card usage; reduced fraud loss; differentiation in a market where cards are often commodity products.

Zimbabwe equivalent?

N/A (no clear publicly documented equivalent found). Zimbabwe banks commonly advertise debit cards and digital banking, but virtual/single-use card controls are not clearly documented in mainstream product pages reviewed. (AFC’s own public channel summaries emphasize banking functions rather than virtual card issuance.) ⁸

International precedents

Revolut virtual card product page and help pages describing subscriptions and single-use cards. ¹⁵

Monzo virtual card documentation (additional precedent). ¹⁷

AFC MyMoney Dashboard via Open Finance

Description

A “single financial view” feature that aggregates customers’ accounts across institutions (banks, wallets, investments) into one dashboard with spending analytics—based on the open banking concept. Barclays describes Open Banking as sharing data with registered companies and enabling new payment methods directly from a current account. ¹⁸

Key features

Account linking (phase-based); spending aggregation; category analytics; “cashflow forecast”; exportable statements for visa/study applications; alerts on fee-heavy behaviors (e.g., frequent ATM cash outs).

Complementary services

Fintech aggregators and data partners; wallet/mobile money providers; eventually regulator-aligned API standards.

Implementation steps (with compliance notes)

- 1) Phase 1 (no APIs): allow customers to upload statements (PDF/CSV) and tag transactions; integrate with AFC transaction history and “manual accounts.”
- 2) Phase 2 (partner APIs): negotiate bilateral data-sharing with 1–2 major providers (starting with wallets or a partner bank) using explicit customer consent.
- 3) Consent and governance: implement opt-in screens, consent expiry, audit logs, and “disconnect” controls (privacy + consumer protection).
- 4) Risk/security: secure storage, encryption, access controls, incident response playbooks; align to banking secrecy requirements.
- 5) Scale: expand compatible providers; introduce data quality scoring and customer dispute mechanisms.

Complexity / time-to-market

High; ~6–12+ months (especially if multi-provider API partnerships are required).

Why it works in Zimbabwe

Gen Z often uses multiple financial rails (bank + wallet + forex/multi-currency). A unified view reduces confusion and supports better decisions; globally, open banking exists to increase customer control and service quality via data portability. ¹⁸

Customer benefits

One dashboard; better budgeting; fewer missed payments; improved financial awareness.

Bank benefits

Primary relationship capture; retention through “high switching cost” dashboard value; better cross-sell to deposits/investments (within regulatory boundaries).

Zimbabwe equivalent?

N/A (no clear publicly documented equivalent found) in major bank product pages reviewed; open banking in the UK relies on FCA-approved providers per Barclays’ description, and a direct analog is not commonly marketed by Zimbabwe banks. ¹⁹

International precedent

Barclays Open Banking explainer pages. ¹⁸

AFC PhoneProtect Packaged Account

Description

A monthly-fee packaged account that includes **mobile phone insurance** (loss/theft/damage/breakdown) plus claims support—designed for Gen Z customers for whom the phone is their “financial identity device.” Nationwide’s FlexPlus current account explicitly includes “Worldwide Family Mobile Phone Insurance” and describes the packaged current account with insurance benefits. ²⁰

Key features

Monthly subscription fee; phone cover for eligible devices; fast claims; replacement/repair partner network; optional add-ons (device cybersecurity education, SIM swap awareness).

Complementary services

Licensed insurer (underwriter); handset repair/replacement chains; device manufacturers/retailers; optional telco partners.

Implementation steps (with compliance notes)

- 1) Partner with a licensed insurer and define underwriting terms; ensure bancassurance governance and disclosures (policy exclusions, excesses, eligibility).
- 2) Build “packaged account” billing: monthly fee collection via AFC account; consistent statements and customer notices.
- 3) Claims workflow integration: in-app claim initiation + hotline; document verification steps; fraud checks.
- 4) Legal and compliance: consumer disclosure pack, complaint handling, and marketing language controls.
- 5) Pilot: start with phones only; expand later to laptop cover for students/young professionals.

Complexity / time-to-market

Medium; ~3–6 months (partner and claims ops are the main work).

Why it works in Zimbabwe

Phone downtime can instantly disrupt income, transfers, and wallets. A packaged bank solution helps customers manage “digital continuity risk” while giving AFC differentiated value beyond standard accounts.

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Customer benefits

Lower financial shock from device loss; convenient claims; peace of mind.

Bank benefits

Fee income; stronger retention; higher card/wallet activity (customers remain digitally active).

Zimbabwe equivalent?

N/A (no clear publicly documented banking packaged account with phone insurance found) in reviewed product pages.

International precedent

Nationwide FlexPlus and its mobile phone insurance pages. 20

Product proposals for pensioners

AFC Care Circle Third-Party Access

Description

A formal, safe way for pensioners to delegate limited account access to a trusted family member/caregiver with explicit boundaries (what can be done, limits, time-bounds). Barclays describes third-party authority as

a temporary arrangement that lets someone you trust access accounts on your behalf, while you “stay in control” and can set limits. ²²

Key features

Third-party authority registration; limits (transaction caps, view-only vs transact); audit trail; instant revocation; trusted-person debit card (optional); fraud escalation hotline.

Complementary services

Elder support NGOs; legal services (power of attorney guidance); trustee/estate partners.

Implementation steps (with compliance notes)

- 1) Define access types (view-only, transact, bill-pay only) and required documentation.
- 2) Add onboarding flow in-branch and in-app with explicit consent + audit logs (important for disputes).
- 3) Configure limits/templates per access type; implement role-based permissions.
- 4) Add real-time alerts to the pensioner and optionally the trusted person for high-risk actions.
- 5) Train branches: “elder financial safety checklists” and escalation paths.

Complexity / time-to-market

Medium; ~**2–4 months** (process + permissions + training).

Why it works in Zimbabwe

Many pensioners rely on family support; a bank-designed safe delegation reduces abuse risk and improves continuity of bill payment and essential spending—especially when pensioners are unwell or less mobile.

Customer benefits

Safer family help; fewer missed bills; more confidence using banking services.

Bank benefits

Lower fraud disputes; higher pensioner retention; improved brand trust.

Zimbabwe equivalent?

N/A (no clear packaged “third-party authority with limits” product found) in the public product pages reviewed.

International precedents

Barclays third-party access pages. ²²

Bank of America elder financial services pages (caregivers/trusted contacts framing). ²³

AFC Digital Life Certificate and Pension Concierge

Description

A pensioner services layer that supports “proof of life” / pension verification through digital channels (video verification and/or secure digital certificates), plus assisted support for pension documentation. SBI describes an Aadhaar-based “Digital Life Certificate” (Jeevan Pramaan) and provides structured pensioner support resources. ²⁴

Key features

Video verification option; document checklist; pension schedule reminders; “pension support desk” (branch + phone); secure storage of pension documents; integration roadmap for NSSA or other pension schemes.

Complementary services

Pension administrators (NSSA and private funds); identity verification vendors; secure video-KYC providers.

Implementation steps (with compliance notes)

- 1) Map the “life certificate” journey in Zimbabwe pension flows (NSSA/private funds) and define a standard AFC support checklist.
- 2) Build secure video verification workflow and identity verification gating; store consent and evidence for audit.
- 3) Integrate reminders into app/SMS for verification due dates.
- 4) Establish pension service desks at selected branches on payout days; measure queue time and resolution.
- 5) Pursue formal integration with pension authorities where feasible; publish consumer notices on data handling.

Complexity / time-to-market

High; ~4–9 months (requires multi-stakeholder agreement and strong identity controls).

Why it works in Zimbabwe

Reduces travel and queue burden, improves dignity and continuity of pension earnings, and aligns with pensioner realities highlighted in NSSA communications (fee sensitivity, operational reliance on certain banks, welfare schemes). ⁵

Customer benefits

Less travel; fewer missed verifications; faster issue resolution.

Bank benefits

Stronger pension inflow capture; operational leadership in pension servicing; improved reputational trust.

Zimbabwe equivalent?

N/A (no clear bank-branded digital life-certificate service found) on public bank product pages reviewed.

International precedents

SBI Digital Life Certificate description and SBI PensionSeva resources. ²⁴

AFC Retirement Investment Wrapper

Description

A dedicated “retirement investment wrapper” that helps pensioners and pre-retirees invest safely into low-risk instruments (money market, T-bills, fixed income funds), with simplified disclosures and optional call-

back guidance. HSBC's SIPP materials show a bank-supported retirement wrapper model and provide guidance and management resources for a self-invested pension. ²⁵

Key features

Retirement goal account; conservative portfolios; automated monthly "pension sweep" allocation; beneficiary prompts; printable statements; optional advisor call-back.

Complementary services

Licensed asset managers/unit trusts; custodial services; securities regulator alignment and disclosures.

Implementation steps (with compliance notes)

- 1) Decide wrapper type: deposit product vs investment product; ensure disclosures about deposit protection differences (DPC explicitly notes asset managers are not covered). ²⁶
- 2) Partner with a regulated asset manager and define funds suitable for retirees (risk-labeled).
- 3) Build app/USSD enrollment flows and a branch "retirement onboarding pack."
- 4) Implement suitability checks and customer education scripts to reduce mis-selling risk.
- 5) Add "pension sweep" rules (opt-in) and clear opt-out controls.

Complexity / time-to-market

Medium-High; **~3-6 months** (faster if launching as an "execution-only" referral to a partner initially).

Why it works in Zimbabwe

Zimbabwe already has accessible money market and investment products through bank groups; the gap is the *retirement-optimized wrapper + guidance*. Examples: CBZ's Datvest provides money market investments; CABS offers investment products; BancABC offers asset management services. ²⁷

Customer benefits

Better inflation defense potential; structured retirement planning; clearer choices.

Bank benefits

Fee income (if structured); stronger wealth relationship; improved retention of pensioner segments.

Zimbabwe equivalent?

Yes (partial): investment products exist (CBZ/CABS/BancABC), but a simplified pensioner-first wrapper is not universally packaged as a retirement "journey." ²⁷

International precedent

HSBC SIPP pages. ²⁵

AFC Rewards for Financial Health

Description

A behavior-based rewards program that measures and rewards "good money behaviors" (saving regularly, keeping buffers, paying bills on time), with pensioner-relevant benefits such as grocery/pharmacy discounts

and airtime/transport rewards. Discovery's Vitality Money is explicitly positioned as a behavior-change program to improve financial health and reward positive behavior. ²⁸

Key features

Financial health score; rewards tiers; partner-funded discounts; savings streak badges; pensioner bundle (pharmacy/grocery and health-adjacent partners).

Complementary services

Retailers (groceries/pharmacies); transport partners; NGOs; merchant-funded rewards marketplaces.

Implementation steps (with compliance notes)

- 1) Define the 4–6 behaviors scored (simple, transparent, non-discriminatory).
- 2) Build scoring engine; publish customer-friendly methodology and complaint process.
- 3) Negotiate merchant-funded rewards; integrate redemption via POS (card-linked offers) or voucher codes.
- 4) Ensure privacy compliance: minimal data sharing; opt-in; anonymize where possible.
- 5) Pilot with pensioners + Gen Z savers, refine rewards economics.

Complexity / time-to-market

Medium; ~4–8 months.

Why it works in Zimbabwe

NSSA has referenced discount grocery schemes and pensioner fee relief via certain banks, indicating that discounts and cost-of-living support are meaningful to pensioners. ⁵ A bank-led rewards layer can expand these benefits beyond a single welfare initiative.

Customer benefits

Lower cost of living; encouragement to save; clear rewards for healthy habits.

Bank benefits

Higher engagement and deposits; interchange growth; stickier customer base via a benefits ecosystem.

Zimbabwe equivalent?

N/A (no clear bank-branded “financial health rewards” program found) in reviewed product pages.

International precedent

Discovery Bank / Vitality Money rewards pages. ²⁹

AFC Senior Safe Mode

Description

A “safety-first” pensioner mode that reduces fraud exposure and simplifies banking: always-on alerts, simplified approval flows for high-risk transactions, and optional assistance through a bank “virtual helper” concept. Bank of America describes online and mobile alerts as helping customers stay in control and protect against fraud, and it positions Erica as a virtual financial assistant that helps with account

information and security-related tasks. ³⁰ Barclays also provides prominent scam reporting and scam-awareness guidance. ³¹

Key features

Always confirm new beneficiaries; high-value transfer “step-up” verification; instant alerts; simplified UI; “call-back verification” option; scam education prompts.

Complementary services

Telco partners for secure call-back routing; fraud intelligence feeds; consumer education partners.

Implementation steps (with compliance notes)

- 1) Define “safe mode” risk rules (new beneficiary, high-value transfer, unusual merchant).
- 2) Implement alert templates via SMS + app (AFC already supports SMS alerts for transactions). ¹
- 3) Add step-up verification: call-back or in-app confirmations; train staff on senior-safe protocols.
- 4) Create a dedicated “fraud help line” and branch escalation SOPs; align with consumer protection expectations and recordkeeping.
- 5) Phase 2: add a lightweight in-app assistant for FAQs and guidance (start scripted, then expand).

Complexity / time-to-market

Medium; ~**2–4 months** for “alerts + safe mode rules,” ~**6–12 months** for an advanced assistant layer.

Why it works in Zimbabwe

Pensioners managing fixed incomes are disproportionately harmed by fraud and mistaken transfers. A safety overlay strengthens trust and aligns with patterns of fee sensitivity and pension-related banking reliance (e.g., NSSA’s commentary on pensioners and partner banks). ³²

Customer benefits

Reduced fraud risk; more confidence; easier support escalation.

Bank benefits

Lower dispute costs; improved NPS; reduced fraud losses; a strong differentiator for pensioner acquisition.

Zimbabwe equivalent?

N/A (no clear pensioner-focused “safe mode + senior fraud journey” package found) in reviewed product pages.

International precedents

Bank of America alerts and Erica pages; Barclays scam reporting guidance. ³³

Comparison table of the 10 proposals

Product name	Zimbabwe equivalent? (Yes/N/A)	Local equivalent provider(s) or N/A	International precedent (official page)
AFC Teen+ Parent Controls Account	Yes (partial)	POSB Youth Account; CBZ CashPlus Junior (parent/guardian-operated) ¹²	Revolut Kids & Teens ¹⁰
AFC RoundUp Goals Pots	N/A	N/A (no clear publicly documented roundup feature found) ¹²	Monzo Roundups ¹³
AFC Virtual Card and Subscription Shield	N/A	N/A	Revolut Virtual Card + Single-use cards ¹⁵ ; Monzo Virtual Cards ¹⁷
AFC MyMoney Dashboard via Open Finance	N/A	N/A	Barclays Open Banking ¹⁸
AFC PhoneProtect Packaged Account	N/A	N/A	Nationwide FlexPlus + Phone Insurance ²⁰
AFC Care Circle Third-Party Access	N/A	N/A	Barclays Third-party access ²²
AFC Digital Life Certificate and Pension Concierge	N/A	N/A	SBI Digital Life Certificate + PensionSeva ²⁴
AFC Retirement Investment Wrapper	Yes (partial)	CBZ Money Market (Datvest); CABS Investment Products; BancABC Asset Management ²⁷	HSBC SIPP ²⁵
AFC Rewards for Financial Health	N/A	N/A	Discovery Vitality Money ³⁴
AFC Senior Safe Mode	N/A	N/A	Bank of America Alerts + Erica ³⁵ ; Barclays scam reporting guidance ³¹

Prioritized recommendation and rollout plan

Quick pilots

AFC RoundUp Goals Pots is the best low-risk pilot because it is primarily a **core + channel feature** that leverages AFC's existing digital rails and can raise deposits without complex third-party dependencies. ¹⁴

AFC Care Circle Third-Party Access is a high-impact pensioner program that is largely **process + permissions + training**, validated by international bank frameworks for third-party authority and caregiver access. ²²

AFC Senior Safe Mode is a fast trust-builder: start with always-on alerts and step-up verification rules (leveraging AFC SMS alerts) before attempting advanced assistant functionality. ³⁶

Strategic builds

AFC MyMoney Dashboard via Open Finance is a long-horizon differentiator; international open banking relies on regulated providers and data-sharing frameworks that AFC would need to replicate through partnerships and/or RBZ-aligned standards over time. ¹⁹

AFC Digital Life Certificate and Pension Concierge is strategic because it requires strong integration and trust workflows with pension administrators, but global precedents show it can dramatically reduce friction for pensioners. ³⁷

Mermaid timeline for rollout phases

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timeline
    title AFC rollout phases for international-derived segment innovations (March 2026)
    0-3 months : RoundUp Goals Pots (feature pilot on app + USSD)
                : Senior Safe Mode v1 (alerts + step-up verification + hotline)
                : Care Circle v1 (third-party authority process + branch enablement)
    3-6 months : Teen+ Parent Controls Account (guardian controls + teen card limits)
                : PhoneProtect Packaged Account (insurer partnership + claims workflow)
                : Retirement Investment Wrapper v1 (partner referral/execution-only)
    6-12+ months : Open Finance Dashboard (phase 1: manual/statement-based; phase 2: partner APIs)
                : Digital Life Certificate & Pension Concierge (video verification + administrator integration)
                : Financial Health Rewards (merchant-funded discounts + scoring model)
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¹ ⁸ ¹⁴ ³⁶ <https://www.afcholdings.co.zw/commercial-bank/individual-banking/>
<https://www.afcholdings.co.zw/commercial-bank/individual-banking/>

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